

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 628

By Keisling

A RESOLUTION to recognize Paul Thompson on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their years of industry; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable person is Paul Thompson, who recently took his much-deserved retirement after nearly three decades with Tri-County Electric, having been the longest-serving CEO in Tri-County Electric history and the longest-serving active CEO in Tennessee at the time of his retirement; and

WHEREAS, a graduate of Macon County High School, Mr. Thompson received his Bachelor of Science degree in Biology from Tennessee Technological University; and

WHEREAS, his illustrious career with Tri-County Electric began in March 1998, when he was named Director of Marketing, in which capacity he served until February 2001, when he was named interim CEO; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Thompson was named CEO of Tri-County Electric in May 2001, and, under his leadership, Tri-County Electric became the first electric cooperative in Kentucky or Tennessee to install automated metering, allowing the cooperative to implement an outage management system that significantly decreased outage times and allowed it to be among the first cooperatives in the country to provide pre-paid metering; and

WHEREAS, his tenure also saw the installation of a NOAA Weather Radio Warning System for Macon County, which led to Tri-County Electric being awarded the Mark Trail Award in 2004, an honor bestowed on those who have made significant contributions to the advancement of weather technology; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Thompson worked with state and local officials to allow electric cooperatives to provide broadband, internet, and phone services to electric cooperative members who had never had access; and

WHEREAS, bringing his distinguished career at Tri-County Electric to a close, Paul Thompson stepped down as CEO of Tri-County Electric in September 2024 but continued to share his knowledge and expertise as an executive consultant to the cooperative until this past March; and

WHEREAS, an active part of his community, Paul Thompson is a past president of the Macon County Chamber of Commerce and helped secure grant funding to build the Leon and Marie Cothron Macon County Welcome Center; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and accolades, he has been lauded as the Macon County Chamber of Commerce Citizen of the Year; and

WHEREAS, a devoted husband, father, and grandfather, Mr. Thompson enjoys the love and support of his wife, Dawn, his sons, Marcus (Kailyn) and Ryan (Savannah), and his grandsons, Riggs and Tate; and

WHEREAS, Paul Thompson exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Paul Thompson has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his colleagues and the customers of Tri-County Electric; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we extend to Paul Thompson our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.